AEP FROM ZERO • PART 4 • MULTIPLY THE TEAM (CAPSTONE)

EPISODE 36

AEP, AJO and CJA Capstone Project: Demo Day

An end-to-end AEP capstone project, presented on Demo Day: run a 12-point checklist across Adobe Experience Platform (AEP), Real-Time CDP, Adobe Journey Optimizer (AJO), Customer Journey Analytics (CJA) and the AI layer, and prove a journey's branches with Dry run instead of Test mode. Learn how to present a technical project in seven minutes by telling it through one customer, plus demo day presentation tips that stop a martech demo breaking live: staged test profiles, a ready event

Free course on iTV • Surge Software Solutions, Bengaluru • Bloom is fictional

Previously: the agent with a brake

- Last time: a 48-hour guardrail tripped in dry run
- Governance note: permissions, stops, approval, a log
- Tomorrow: Demo Day, in front of the board
- Today: check the build, shape the story, stage it
- Goal: one customer the board can truly see

KEY IDEA

Kavya's agent tripped a 48-hour guardrail in dry run. Now six weeks of work must become one seven-minute story for tomorrow's board.

The day before the board

- Format: 7-minute talk, then 8 minutes of questions
- 12 points, one for every seam in the build
- Green: evidence attached. Amber: a written caveat
- Red: fixed today, before anyone rehearses
- Green means a row, a count or a screenshot

KEY IDEA

Seven minutes to present, eight minutes of questions. First, a 12-point checklist proves every seam of the build still holds.

Checklist points one to six

- 1 Schemas: Enabled for Profile column re-checked
- 2 Ingestion: Records in Profile, not just the lake
- 3 Identity: Priya by email or BloomID, one profile
- 4 Audiences: Lapsed 90 still says 90 days
- 5 Activation: hashed email and band only (amber)
- 6 Welcome journey: branches not proven (red)

KEY IDEA

Schemas, ingestion, identity, audiences, activation and the welcome journey: each point needs evidence on screen, not memory.

Prove the welcome branches with Dry run

Test mode: both seats got the email

▼

Both seats took the top branch

▼

So Others was never proven

▼

Dry run: real profiles per path

▼

Counts on Gold Members and Others

▼

Evidence replaced: point six green

KEY IDEA

Test mode takes the top branch of a split, so it proves the email, not the paths. Dry run's path counts prove both branches.

Checklist points seven to twelve

- 7 Cart Rescue v1: purchase exit, 7-day re-entry, holdout
- 8 Decisioning: offers approved, Free Shipping fallback
- 9 Guardrails: 2 emails a week, every marketing message
- 10 Data view: stitched person ID, No value labelled
- 11 Closed loop: Checkout Leakers feed Checkout Rescue
- 12 AI evidence: sheet, golden set, agent dry-run log

KEY IDEA

Cart rescue, decisioning, guardrails, the data view, the closed loop and the AI evidence: eleven green, one honest amber.

Present a technical project in seven minutes

Part	Time	What to show
Problem	About 1 minute	What the business could not do
Architecture	About 1 minute	One simple picture of the flow
Walkthrough	About 3 minutes	The build, through one person
Numbers	About 1 minute	Each with its baseline
AI layer	About 1 minute	What it does, how it's checked

A suggested split, not a rule

KEY IDEA

Five parts: problem, architecture, walkthrough, numbers, AI layer. Tell it through one person, not a box diagram.

Priya: anonymous to loyal in six beats

7:44 PM: an anonymous add to cart

▼

Sign-in stitches the ECID to email

▼

Gold Members; never a cart abandoner

▼

Cart Rescue v1 lets her go at 7:52

▼

CJA: one person, no false abandon

▼

The change: Checkout Rescue

KEY IDEA

Anonymous visit, stitched identity, audiences, journey, measurement, and the change Bloom made. One person, six beats, no detours.

Demo hygiene: stage it, then plan to fail

- Stable test profiles, staged the day before
- Event payload ready, aimed only at your own seat
- Screens loaded before the panel arrives
- A screenshot of every screen, in order, two clicks away
- Rehearse in the real sandbox at presenting time
- Never click Activate, Publish or send in a demo

KEY IDEA

Staged test profiles, a ready event payload, loaded screens, and a screenshot of every screen two clicks away, because something will break.

The dress rehearsal

First timed run: far too long

▼

Cut screens Priya does not need

▼

Short slot? Use the five-minute spine

▼

Practise the switch to screenshots

▼

Write the three questions you fear

▼

Answer each on paper, with a trade-off

KEY IDEA

The first timed run took nearly twice seven minutes. Cut the detours, rehearse the failure path, and write down the three questions you fear.

Show business value from a CDP project

Test	Bloom example
Window: which dates?	Relaunch fortnight: 1,240 orders
Model: who gets the credit?	Named beside channel revenue
Baseline: compared with what?	Holdout recovery: 7.9%
Caveat: how solid is it?	Two weeks of data: soft

KEY IDEA

Give every number its window, its model and its baseline. Compare against a holdout, and call soft numbers soft before anyone asks.

Kavya calls her own number soft

Number	Window and model	Honest note
1,240 orders, 66,260 dollars	Relaunch fortnight	A count; no comparison yet
Revenue by channel	Last Touch, 30 days	520 orders: No value
Gold average order: 78	Relaunch fortnight	Silver 55, Bronze 38
Cart Rescue: 11.8%	Fortnight, vs holdout	Holdout 7.9%: soft

KEY IDEA

Rohan checked every figure on Kavya's slide for its model and window, and she labelled the soft one herself.

Demo Day: the screen that stalled

Problem: who is our customer?

▼

Memory, voice, eyes and colleague

▼

Walkthrough: the live screen stalls

▼

Two clicks: the same screen, captured

▼

Numbers with baselines; AI checked

▼

Finished inside seven minutes

KEY IDEA

Three minutes in, the live profile screen stalled. Kavya opened the same screen from her screenshot folder and never broke the story.

The question she feared

- Feared question: can you find anyone by BloomID?
- Honest answer: not yet, only customers who ordered
- Trade-off: one identity, Email, on the customer schema
- Differently: settle identity design on day one
- Unknown? Say how you would find out

KEY IDEA

Asked about BloomID, Kavya named the trade-off and what she would change. Asked something she did not know, she said how she would find out.

The rubric, peer scoring and judgement

Criterion	Points	Full marks means
Architecture story	20	Survives why this design
Live walkthrough	30	Works live; fallbacks graceful
Business value	20	Each capability has a number
Panel questions	20	Direct, honest, no bluffing
Clarity and time	10	On time; anyone can follow

Demo Day rubric, 100 points

KEY IDEA

A 100-point rubric, published in advance, marks judgement, not coverage. Every team member scored two others: one strength, one improvement.

Interview corner

- “I don't know, but here is how I would find out.”
- Then name the evidence you would check
- Name your trade-off before the panel finds it
- Every number: its window, model and baseline

KEY IDEA

Say it in one sentence: I don't know, but here is how I would find out. Then name the evidence you would check.

Recap, your question, and a recruiter

- 12 points, each with evidence; Dry run proves splits
- Seven minutes, five parts, told through Priya
- Staged seats, ready payload, screenshots two clicks away
- Window, model, baseline; call soft numbers soft
- Next: the interview bootcamp

KEY IDEA

Prove every seam, tell it through one customer, and give numbers baselines. Next: a recruiter calls, and Vikram plays the panel.